Flexible: Smart contracts are executed based on conditions written onto platforms.

In recent years, blockchain has become a trend similar to the way cloud computing was in the mid-2000s and providing professionals, developers and R&D professionals with strong opportunities across various sectors. According to Upwork's skills index, blockchain is the fastest growing skill in the IT sector. As per Burning Glass Technologies, there will be more than 6000+ job openings in this field over the next 5-13 months. So, building a career in blockchain is a good decision in the present scenario. Blockchain technology is transforming companies into more efficient and trustworthy organisations. As it is a new technology, there is a huge shortage of skilled professionals, and big industries and enterprises are leaving no stone unturned to find blockchain experts and giving them a jumpstart in positions and salaries. So, if you are looking for good opportunities in blockchain technology, this article will provide must-needed information with regard to career roles and positions, certifications, technical skills, and even the requirements in the industry.

Career roles and positions in blockchain technology

Like any other technology stack, blockchain needs roles that vary from architects and developers to consultants and testers. However, there are some basic differences as this is an emerging technology where there is good scope for a lot of research related roles. Table 1 lists a few popular roles in blockchain based application development.

Role	Role description
Technical analyst	Handles technical research with respect to platform suitability.
Platform architect	Overall SPOC for blockchain application design and infrastructure design.
Business analyst/Functional consultant	Helps in understanding the functional and non-functional requirements, and oversees use case development, test case development, test data preparation.
Frontend designer	Prepares the user experience/journey for UI design.
Blockchain engineer (including DevOps role)	Implements the blockchain application and DevOps pipeline activities.
Security consultant	Helps to design the platform security, application security, data security and network/communication security involved in the application design.
Test engineer	Works on test preparation and execution.
Data engineer	Works on data modelling (conceptual, logical and physical), and data driven design related activities.
Design architect	Prepares the solution design along with the platform architect and security consultant for shaping up the components and interfacing activities.

Table 1: Popular roles in blockchain based application development

There are other intermediary roles depending on the size, volume and complexity of application development, which may also crossover to other disciplinary roles such as AI engineer to implement machine learning based verification mechanism in a blockchain platform, Big Data architect who helps to design complex data design in blockchain application design, and cloud architect who helps to design the Infrastructure-as-a-Service design of a cloud based blockchain platform (e.g., Azure, AWS, GCP based blockchain services).

Certifications in blockchain

Some common and popular certifications help you build your career in blockchain technology. The most popular are listed here. There is no recommendation or endorsement of any of these courses. They are merely listed here to show how to walk the path to building a career in blockchain.

University of Nicosia

The University of Nicosia offers multiple blockchain courses and certifications.

- **Blockchain Developer certification**: Intended for developers to understand blockchain basics, cryptocurrency programming and security frameworks.
- **Blockchain Business Analyst certification**: Intended for consultants to understand regulatory frameworks in cryptocurrencies, and business considerations for design and development of a blockchain platform
- **Blockchain Analyst certification**: Intended for functional and technical analysts to understand open financial systems, digital payment transactions, and application of blockchain platforms in digital payment platforms.

This university is also the first in the world to offer an M.Sc in Digital Currency, which covers blockchain and distributed ledger technology.

Blockchain Institute of Technology (BIT)

BIT offers professional certifications like Certified Blockchain Professional